

Essays in Empirical Finance

A thesis submitted to The University of Manchester
for the degree of PhD
in the Faculty of Humanities.

2027

Avery L. Reader

Alliance Manchester Business School, MSM

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Preface

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List of publications

Reader, Avery. & Co-author, A. (2026). *Title of the first paper*. Journal Name, in press.

Reader, Avery., Co-author, A. & Co-author, B. (2026). *Title of the second paper*. Manuscript under review.

Reader, Avery. & Co-author, C. (2026). *Title of the third paper*. Manuscript in preparation.

Abstract

The University of Manchester

Avery L Reader

PhD

Essays in Empirical Finance

2027

Write your abstract here. The University policy (section 8.1.e) requires that the abstract not exceed one page; aim for under 350 words at 12pt with 1.5 line spacing. State the research question, the methodological approach, the principal findings, and the contribution.

Declaration of originality

I declare that no portion of the work referred to in this thesis has been submitted in support of an application for another degree or qualification of this or any other university or other institute of learning.

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Acknowledgements

Write your acknowledgements here. Policy section 9.1.b allows a dedication and acknowledgements after the compulsory preliminary pages. Acknowledgements do not count toward the main-text word limit.

Chapter 1

Introduction

1.1 Research objectives and motivation

State the motivation for the research and the overarching question(s) the thesis addresses. As Smith and Johnson (2024) argue, the field has evolved rapidly; (doe2020book?) provides a useful textbook framing.

1.2 Thesis overview

Provide an overview of the three constituent papers and how they relate to one another. Per policy section 13.10, include here the rationale for submitting in journal format and an account of how the thesis has been constructed.

1.3 Thesis structure

Summarise the structure of the remaining chapters.

References

- [] Park, M.-J. (2022) ‘An example book chapter’, in A. Editor and B. Editor (eds) *Handbook of examples*. Example Press, pp. 101–128.
- [] Smith, J.A. and Johnson, M.B. (2024) ‘An example journal article’, *Example Journal of Research*, 18(3), pp. 245–267. Available at: <https://doi.org/10.1234/exj.2024.18.3>.

Chapter 2

Title of the first paper

Preface

Contribution statement

Briefly describe the candidate's contribution to this paper, e.g.: I designed the study, collected the data, performed the analysis, and wrote the manuscript. Co-author A advised on the methodology.

State the publication status of the paper here (e.g., *published in Journal Name, 2024*; *under review at Journal Name*; *in preparation*).

2.1 Abstract

Concise paper-style abstract. State the question, methods, principal findings, and contribution in 150–250 words.

2.2 Introduction

Set up the research question. As Smith and Johnson (2024) show, the literature on this topic has grown rapidly. The position taken by (doe2020book?) is that ...; the present paper extends this by [your contribution]. See also Park (2022) for a complementary perspective.

2.3 Methodology

The model is estimated by ordinary least squares. The estimating equation is:

$$y_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_{1i} + \beta_2 x_{2i} + \varepsilon_i \quad (2.1)$$

where $\varepsilon_i \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2)$ are independent and identically distributed error terms. Equation 2.1 is the workhorse specification.

Inline mathematics works too — for example, the t-statistic is $t = \hat{\beta}/\text{SE}(\hat{\beta})$.

2.4 Data

The sample comprises $n = 240$ observations drawn from three sources. Descriptive statistics are reported in Table 2.1.

Table 2.1: Descriptive statistics of the sample.

Variable	Mean	SD	Min	Max
Age	27.3	3.1	22	39
Programme year	2.4	1.0	1	4
Outcome score	4.8	1.2	1.5	6.9

2.5 Results

Figure 2.1 shows the distribution of the outcome variable.

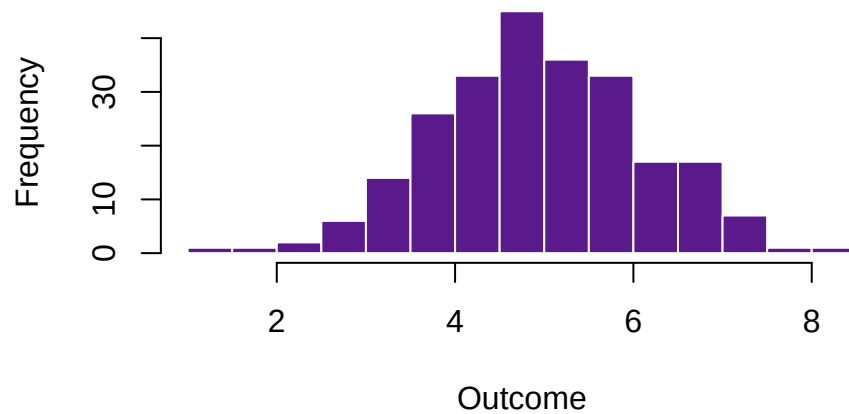


Figure 2.1: Distribution of the outcome variable.

The estimated coefficients are reported in Table 2.2.

Table 2.2: Estimated regression coefficients from the specification in Equation Equation 2.1.

Coefficient	Estimate	Std. error	t-value	p-value
Intercept	4.92	0.15	32.8	< 0.001
x_1	0.34	0.10	3.4	0.001
x_2	-0.18	0.10	-1.8	0.073

The slope on x_1 is positive and significant at the 1% level.

2.6 Discussion

Interpret the results. Discuss what the findings imply for theory and practice.

2.7 Conclusions

Summarise the contribution of this paper.

References

The bibliography below is auto-generated from `references.bib` and the citations used above.

- [] Park, M.-J. (2022) ‘An example book chapter’, in A. Editor and B. Editor (eds) *Handbook of examples*. Example Press, pp. 101–128.
- [] Smith, J.A. and Johnson, M.B. (2024) ‘An example journal article’, *Example Journal of Research*, 18(3), pp. 245–267. Available at: <https://doi.org/10.1234/exj.2024.18.3>.

Appendices

2.A Sample survey instrument

Reproduce the survey instrument used to collect the primary data.

2.B Robustness checks

Document any robustness checks. Use sub-sub-sections for grouped material:

2.B.1 Excluding outliers

Outlier exclusion does not change the headline result.

2.B.2 Bootstrap standard errors

Bootstrap standard errors confirm the parametric inferences.

Chapter 3

Title of the second paper

Preface

Contribution statement

Briefly describe the candidate's contribution to this paper.

State the publication status of the paper here.

3.1 Abstract

Concise paper-style abstract.

3.2 Introduction

3.3 Literature review

3.4 Methodology

3.5 Data

3.6 Results

3.7 Discussion

3.8 Conclusions

References

- [] Park, M.-J. (2022) ‘An example book chapter’, in A. Editor and B. Editor (eds) *Handbook of examples*. Example Press, pp. 101–128.
- [] Smith, J.A. and Johnson, M.B. (2024) ‘An example journal article’, *Example Journal of Research*, 18(3), pp. 245–267. Available at: <https://doi.org/10.1234/exj.2024.18.3>.

Appendices

3.A Supplementary material

3.B Additional analysis

Chapter 4

Title of the third paper

Preface

Contribution statement

Briefly describe the candidate's contribution to this paper.

State the publication status of the paper here.

4.1 Abstract

Concise paper-style abstract.

4.2 Introduction

4.3 Literature review

4.4 Methodology

4.5 Data

4.6 Results

4.7 Conclusions

References

- [] Park, M.-J. (2022) ‘An example book chapter’, in A. Editor and B. Editor (eds) *Handbook of examples*. Example Press, pp. 101–128.
- [] Smith, J.A. and Johnson, M.B. (2024) ‘An example journal article’, *Example Journal of Research*, 18(3), pp. 245–267. Available at: <https://doi.org/10.1234/exj.2024.18.3>.

Appendices

4.A Supplementary material

Chapter 5

Conclusions

5.1 Implications and future research

Summarise the implications of the three papers and outline directions for future research.

5.2 Summary

Provide a brief summary of the overall contribution of the thesis.

References

- [] Park, M.-J. (2022) ‘An example book chapter’, in A. Editor and B. Editor (eds) *Handbook of examples*. Example Press, pp. 101–128.
- [] Smith, J.A. and Johnson, M.B. (2024) ‘An example journal article’, *Example Journal of Research*, 18(3), pp. 245–267. Available at: <https://doi.org/10.1234/exj.2024.18.3>.